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On Air · Sunny

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Turn It Down: Earphones and Hearing Loss

By Sunny · 2026-08-24 · 220 words · L3



이어폰 볼륨과 청력 손상

Many young people spend hours every day listening to music through earphones or headphones. But doctors are now warning that high volume levels can seriously damage hearing over time.

When Sound Becomes Harmful

The human ear has tiny hair cells inside that pick up sound waves and send signals to the brain. When sound is too loud, these hair cells can get damaged or even die. Once they are gone, the body cannot grow them back, and the hearing loss becomes permanent.

Some researchers say that listening at high volumes for long periods is especially risky for young people. Even sounds at a level similar to heavy street traffic may begin to harm your ears after just a couple of hours.

Safe Habits for Your Ears

Some health experts suggest a simple rule: keep the volume below 60 percent of the maximum, and take a break after about an hour. Short breaks give your ears time to recover.

Over-ear headphones are generally safer than in-ear earphones because they sit farther from the eardrum. Noise-cancelling headphones can also help by blocking outside sounds, so you feel less need to raise the volume.

Protecting your hearing now can make a real difference later in life. Small daily habits, like keeping the volume low, can keep your ears healthy for years to come.

한글 요약

이어폰이나 헤드폰으로 높은 볼륨의 음악을 오래 들으면 귀 안의 유모세포가 손상되어 영구적인 청력 손실로 이어질 수 있다. 전문가들은 볼륨을 최대치의 60퍼센트 이하로 유지하고 한 시간마다 휴식을 취할 것을 권장한다. 또한 인이어 이어폰보다 오버이어 헤드폰이나 노이즈 캔슬링 헤드폰을 사용하는 것이 귀 건강에 더 도움이 된다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

permanent	영구적인	eardrum	고막
damage	손상시키다	temptation	유혹
exposure	노출	recover	회복하다
decibel	데시벨 (소리의 단위)		

Balancing Sports and Studies at School

By Sunny · 2026-08-24 · 167 words · L2



학교 운동부와 공부의 균형

Many students who play on school sports teams find it hard to keep up with their schoolwork at the same time. Practice sessions, travel to competitions, and physical tiredness can all make studying more difficult.

Student athletes often have very full schedules. On some days, they train for two or more hours after school and then go home to finish homework. This leaves little time to rest.

Some schools have put rules in place to help students manage both sports and studies. For

example, a student may need to keep their grades at a certain level to stay on the team. This gives players a reason to take their schoolwork seriously.

Finding the right balance is not always easy, but many students say it is possible with good time management. Prioritizing — deciding which tasks matter most — is a skill that student athletes often build over time. Interestingly, staying active through sports may also help the brain stay focused, which can make study time more productive.

한글 요약

학교 스포츠 팀에 속한 학생 선수들은 훈련과 학업을 함께 병행해야 하기 때문에 시간적 여유가 부족한 경우가 많다. 일부 학교는 일정 성적을 유지해야 팀에 남을 수 있는 규칙을 두어 학생들이 학업에도 신경 쓰도록 유도하고 있다. 철저한 시간 관리와 우선순위 설정을 통해 운동과 공부의 균형을 잡는 것이 가능하며, 꾸준한 신체 활동이 오히려 집중력 향상에 도움이 될 수 있다.

Source · timeforkids.com

WORDS & MEANINGS

athlete 운동선수

schedule 일정, 스케줄

competition 경쟁, 대회

manage (일을) 해내다, 관리하다

grade 성적, 학년

balance 균형

productive 생산적인

Racing to Save the World's Lost Languages

By Sunny · 2026-08-24 · 138 words · L1



사라져가는 언어를 기록하는 사람들

Around the world, thousands of languages are slowly disappearing every year. When the last speaker of a language dies, that language is gone forever. Experts say this is a serious loss for all of humanity.

Today, about 7,000 languages exist on Earth, but nearly half of them are in danger. Some languages have only a small number of elderly speakers left.

Language experts called field linguists travel to remote areas to meet these speakers. They

record voices, write down words, and build dictionaries to preserve what remains. Projects like Wikitongues use technology to store these recordings safely online for the future.

This work matters deeply because language carries history, stories, and culture. When a language disappears, all of that knowledge disappears with it. Thanks to these dedicated researchers, some languages may survive as digital records for future generations.

한글 요약

전 세계적으로 매년 수천 개의 언어가 사라지고 있으며, 현재 약 7,000개의 언어 중 절반 가까이가 위기에 처해 있다. 현장 언어학자들은 오지를 직접 찾아가 사라져가는 언어를 녹음하고 사전으로 기록하는 작업을 하고 있다. '위키텅스' 같은 프로젝트가 기술을 활용해 이 기록들을 온라인에 보존함으로써, 언어 속에 담긴 역사와 문화가 미래 세대에게 전해질 수 있도록 노력하고 있다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

disappear 사라지다
language 언어
speaker 말하는 사람, 화자
record 기록하다

linguist 언어학자
endangered 위기에 처한
digital 디지털의
generation 세대

Museums Around the World Return Old Artifacts

By Sunny · 2026-08-24 · 137 words · L1



박물관이 유물을 돌려주는 문제

Some of the world's biggest museums are giving back objects that they have kept for many years. These objects were often taken from other countries long ago, during times of war or colonial rule.

Returning an object to its home country is called repatriation. Many people believe that artifacts belong with the culture that made them. However, some museums argue that they can protect and share these objects with the world.

In recent years, countries such as Germany and France have returned artifacts to Nigeria and other nations. The British Museum still holds thousands of objects that other countries want back, including famous sculptures from Greece.

This debate is growing louder around the world. Some museums are now working with home countries to decide together what is fair. It is a big question with no easy answer.

한글 요약

세계 유명 박물관들이 오래전 전쟁이나 식민 지배 시기에 가져온 유물들을 원래 나라에 돌려주고 있다. 많은 사람들은 유물이 그것을 만든 문화권에 있어야 한다고 주장하지만, 일부 박물관들은 유물을 보호하고 세계와 공유할 수 있다는 입장을 고수한다. 대영박물관의 그리스 조각품처럼 반환 문제는 아직 해결되지 않은 경우가 많아, 박물관과 각 나라가 함께 공정한 해결책을 찾으려 노력하고 있다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

artifact 유물, 문화재

return 돌려주다, 반환하다

colonial 식민지의

repatriation 본국 송환, 반환

culture 문화

argue 주장하다

debate 토론, 논쟁

protect 보호하다

Why Used Textbooks Change Hands

By Sunny · 2026-08-24 · 218 words · L3



중고 교과서가 오가는 이유

Every year, millions of students buy new textbooks for school. But new textbooks can be very expensive, and families often look for a cheaper way.

The Cost Problem

Textbooks are costly because publishers spend a lot of money writing, printing, and updating them. In some countries, a single textbook costs as much as a family's weekly food budget. As a result, many students and parents feel that buying new books every year puts too much pressure on their wallets.

A Smart Solution

Used textbooks offer a simple answer. A student who has already finished a course can sell their old book

to someone who needs it. The seller gets a little money back, and the buyer pays much less than the full price. Both sides benefit from the deal.

Online platforms have made this even easier. Students can now list their books on websites or apps, and buyers from anywhere can find them quickly. Some schools also set up their own exchange programs so students can trade books with each other.

Interestingly, publishers sometimes release new editions of a textbook just to reduce the number of used copies in the market. This keeps the demand for new books high. Because of this, used copies of older editions can become very popular among students who want to save money.

한글 요약

새 교과서는 가격이 비싸 학생과 학부모에게 큰 경제적 부담이 되고 있다. 중고 교과서 거래는 판매자와 구매자 모두에게 이익이 되는 해결책으로, 온라인 플랫폼과 학교 교환 프로그램을 통해 더욱 활성화되고 있다. 한편 출판사들은 중고 시장을 줄이기 위해 새 판을 출시하지만, 오히려 이전 판의 중고 교과서를 찾는 학생들이 늘어나는 결과를 낳기도 한다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

expensive	비싼	exchange	교환하다; 교환
publisher	출판사	demand	수요
edition	판(版), 개정판	benefit	이익을 얻다; 혜택
platform	플랫폼, (온라인) 서비스		

Earbuds That Translate Languages While You Travel

By Sunny · 2026-08-24 · 133 words · L1



번역 이어폰이 바꾸는 여행

Some earbuds can now translate spoken words in real time. You hear a foreign language, and the device turns it into your own language in seconds. This is changing how people travel.

Companies like Waverly Labs and Google have made earbuds with built-in translation. The Pilot earpiece and Google Pixel Buds are two well-known examples. They connect to apps that recognize speech and translate it quickly.

These earbuds can be especially helpful in places where people speak a very different language. A traveler can talk to a local person without knowing any of their words. This makes travel much less stressful.

These devices may also help people in new countries communicate with others around them. As the technology improves, more languages will be supported. Translation earbuds could soon become a common travel tool.

한글 요약

실시간 번역 기능이 탑재된 이어버드가 등장하면서 외국어를 몰라도 현지인과 대화할 수 있게 되었다. 구글 픽셀 버즈와 파일럿 이어피스 같은 제품들이 대표적인 예로, 음성 인식 앱과 연결해 빠르게 번역을 제공한다. 기술이 더욱 발전하면 번역 이어버드는 여행자들이 흔히 사용하는 필수 도구가 될 것으로 보인다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

translate 번역하다

real time 실시간

device 기기, 장치

built-in 내장된

recognize 인식하다

local 현지의, 지역의

support 지원하다

Repair Shops Are Making a Comeback

By Sunny · 2026-08-24 · 116 words · L1



옷을 고쳐 입는 수선 가게가 늘어난다

More and more people are taking old clothes to repair shops. They choose to fix clothes instead of throwing them away. Fast fashion means buying cheap clothes very often. It creates a huge amount of waste every year.

Repair shops offer a better and more sustainable choice. A skilled tailor can fix torn seams and broken zippers. Tailors can also repair damaged buttons and adjust clothes to fit better. Repairing clothes saves money and reduces waste in landfills.

Many young people around the world are joining the slow fashion movement. They want to buy fewer clothes and use each item for a longer time. Repairing clothes is one simple but meaningful way to make that happen.

한글 요약

패스트 패션으로 인한 환경 문제가 심각해지면서, 옷을 버리는 대신 수선 집에서 고쳐 입는 사람들이 늘어나고 있다. 숙련된 재봉사는 지퍼, 단추, 솔기 등을 수리해 옷의 수명을 늘려주며, 이는 돈 절약과 쓰레기 감소에도 도움이 된다. 전 세계 젊은이들 사이에서 슬로우 패션 운동이 확산되면서, 옷을 수선해 오래 입는 문화가 주목받고 있다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

repair 수선하다, 고치다
tailor 재봉사, 옷 수선사
torn 찢어진
seam 솔기, 바느질선

zipper 지퍼
waste 낭비, 쓰레기
environment 환경
fashion 패션, 유행

Why School Safety Zones Are Hard to Follow

By Sunny · 2026-08-24 · 138 words · L1



학교 앞 안전 구역이 지켜지지 않는 이유

Many countries have special safety zones near schools. In these zones, drivers must slow down and follow strict rules to protect children. However, many drivers do not follow the rules.

There are several reasons for this. Some drivers are in a hurry and do not want to slow down. Others may not notice the signs because they are not clear enough. Some roads near schools are also very busy, which makes it hard for drivers to stop safely.

Enforcing the rules is also difficult. There are not always enough police officers to watch every school zone. Some schools do not have speed cameras, so drivers do not worry about getting caught.

Many parents and teachers want stronger action. They hope that better signs, more cameras, and regular checks will help keep children safe on their way to school.

한글 요약

학교 근처 안전 구역에서 규칙을 지키지 않는 운전자들이 많아 어린이들의 안전이 위협받고 있다. 서두름, 부족한 표지판, 단속 인력 부족 등이 주요 원인으로 꼽힌다. 학부모와 교사들은 더 명확한 표지판, 카메라 확대 설치, 정기 단속 등 강력한 안전 대책 마련을 촉구하고 있다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

safety zone 안전 구역

strict 엄격한

enforce 시행하다, 단속하다

notice 알아채다, 인식하다

speed camera 과속 단속 카메라

regular 정기적인

protect 보호하다

스크랩하기 Scrap It!

이름 _____ 날짜 _____ 학교 · 반 _____

1. 이번 호 기사 목록 — 스크랩할 기사에 □ 표시하세요

- ☐ **건강** Turn It Down: Earphones and Hearing Loss
 - ☐ **스포츠** Balancing Sports and Studies at School
 - ☐ **세계** Racing to Save the World's Lost Languages
 - ☐ **문화** Museums Around the World Return Old Artifacts
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2. 스크랩할 기사 · 제목과 섹션

3. 기사 요약 (3문장)

4. 새로 배운 단어 5개 · 뜻

5. 내 생각 · 이 기사가 중요한 이유